



Hands-on with Snapdragon X Elite laptops

We checked out Snapdragon X Elite AI PC laptops from Acer, Lenovo, Samsung, and Microsoft at Computex 2024 and here's what we found out

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On the opening day of Computex 2024, in a quiet demo room devoid of much fanfare, Qualcomm showed a much-anticipated first glimpse of its latest Snapdragon X Elite-based OEM laptops and tablets. That's right, after smartphones, Qualcomm chips are now

powering laptops. And they're aiming to bring some of their learnings from smartphones over to laptops, boldly proclaiming it as a rebirth of the traditional PC by making it a lot smarter for AI and beyond.

The Snapdragon X Elite is an ARM64 System-on-Chip (SoC) designed by

Qualcomm, consisting of a 12-core Oryon CPU, DirectX 12 compatible Adreno GPU, and Hexagon NPU with 45 TOPS (trillion operations per second) for all the AI goodness. During its launch, Qualcomm benchmark tests of the Snapdragon X Elite on a Microsoft Surface Laptop 7 claimed impressive battery life and multi-thread performance better than that of the MacBook Air M3! The kool-aid can be intoxicating, but is it really that good?

I couldn't obviously test or run any benchmarks with my limited time on the four Snapdragon X Elite demo laptops, but in the few minutes a few things were clear. Qualcomm is definitely onto something here, with a serious chance of making inroads into the traditional PC market dominated by the likes of Intel and AMD until now.

Acer Swift 14: Unleashing the power of NPU

Looked just like a regular Acer Swift 14 laptop until I saw the Snapdragon X Elite sticker next to the trackpad. Windows 11 ran smoothly, apps opened and closed quickly, and the dedicated Copilot key